listened while I gave my usual pitch about my willingness to take *any* job to get a start in radio.

"Where were you yesterday?" he demanded.

He said he *did* have an opening for an announcer and held auditions for it the day before, after advertising the job for a month over the air.

"The job's filled. Where ye been?" he said as if I were a little backward.

I didn't want to tell him we didn't listen much to WOC in Dixon.

After losing the job at Montgomery Ward the week before, this was too much. In a daze, I left his office and headed for the elevator, shattered by the bad luck. "How the hell," I said as I walked away, quietly, but loud enough for him to hear, "can you get to be a sports announcer if you can't even get a job at a radio station?"

I reached the end of the hall and pushed the elevator button. As the door opened, I heard Pete's canes shuffling toward me, then a raspy voice, as rough as sandpaper. "Hold on, you big bastard," he said.

I turned around and saw him advancing toward me atop his canes, first on one and then the other, and let the elevator descend without me.

"What was that you said about *sports* announcing?" he asked.

I told him I wanted to get a job in radio because eventually I wanted to become a sports announcer.

"De ye know anything about football?"

"I played football for eight years in high school and college. . . ."

"Could ye tell me about a football game and make me *see* it as if I was home listening to the radio?"

"Yes . . . I'm sure I could," I replied with the bravado of youth.

"Come with me," he said.